

GUERRILLA MARKETING

Guerrilla Marketing challenges delegates to design bold, unconventional, and high-impact marketing campaigns that thrive on creativity and surprise. Delegates will experiment with viral content, ambush tactics, and experiential setups to capture maximum audience attention and disrupt traditional business models. This category tests innovation, adaptability, and the ability to think outside the box while keeping campaigns audience-focused and strategically sound.

Round 1: Social Media Virality Challenge (NOT AN ELIMINATION ROUND)

ROUND DURATION: 2 HOURS

DELEGATE CAP: 3

Teams will be allotted a specific business niche (for example, soft drinks, cookies, skincare, stationery, etc.) prior to the category. Within their assigned niche, teams must conceptualize an innovative new product that offers a clear added value beyond existing products in the market.

Teams will develop their product concept and create a maximum 60-second mock viral social media announcement video in a TikTok-style or Instagram Reel format. All required content and materials must be submitted at the assigned submission time, which will be communicated to teams prior to the category. Humour is strongly encouraged! Teams are welcome to lean into comedy, absurdity, satire, relatable situations, or anything else that makes their Reel genuinely entertaining and shareable.

In their 2-minute pitch, teams must present their product and explain its added value, target audience, and how their social media campaign could generate attention and achieve virality.

Judging Criteria:

- Innovation and originality of the product
- Clear and meaningful added value
- Creativity of the social media concept
- Shareability and potential for virality
- Clarity and effectiveness of the message

Round 2: Ambush Marketing

ROUND DURATION: 2 HOURS

DELEGATE CAP: 3

This is the elimination round.

Each team will continue with the same product they worked on in Round 1. For this round, each team will be assigned a real-world competitor or competing brand/business model. Their task is to hijack attention from this competitor by creating an ambush marketing campaign.

Teams must design a campaign that builds on their viral product idea from Round 1 and transform it into an ambush marketing stunt targeting their assigned competitor. They will then deliver a 3–4 minute pitch covering:

- Which real-world competitor they are targeting
- How their viral idea can be scaled into an ambush marketing stunt
- How the campaign will steal attention from the competitor
- Why their campaign has the potential to generate maximum reach and impact

Teams are encouraged to use creative methods to explain their campaign, such as billboard posters, video ads, storyboard sketches, rough visuals, surprise props, hijacking hashtags, or other innovative tactics. These are only suggestions, and teams are free to explore any feasible and creative approach that best captures attention.

Judging Criteria:

- Originality of Idea
- Ability to hijack attention
- Reach & Impact Potential
- Clarity & Delivery of Pitch
- Use of Creative Methods

Round 3: The Stall Setup Showdown

ROUND DURATION: 3 HOURS

DELEGATE CAP: 3

In the final round, delegates will bring their guerrilla marketing campaigns full circle by transforming their ideas from the previous rounds into a physical brand experience.

Teams must design and set up a stall that captures the identity of their brand and campaign while attracting, engaging, and leaving a lasting impression on an audience. The stall should serve as a physical extension of the ideas developed throughout the previous rounds.

Teams may use props, visuals, slogans, games, interactive elements, demonstrations, or other creative tactics to make their stall memorable and engaging. They are free to explore any feasible approach that best represents their brand and campaign.

THE TWIST: KNOW YOUR AUDIENCE

During the final presentation, one of the judges will take on a surprise audience persona and interact with the team as a potential customer. The persona may present a specific challenge, concern, or need that the team must respond to through their marketing.

The persona may be, for example: -

- A concerned parent questioning whether the product is suitable for their child
- A student on a tight budget
- A skeptical customer who doesn't see the value of the product
- A customer looking for a more sustainable option
- A customer who strongly prefers a competitor's product

Teams will not know which persona they will receive beforehand. They must think on their feet and adapt their pitch, messaging, and sales strategy to convince this particular audience.

Following the interaction, teams will pitch their overall stall and campaign to the judges and may be asked additional questions about their strategy and execution.

Resource Over Budget

This round is designed to test creativity and resourcefulness, not spending power. Teams are not expected or encouraged to spend large amounts of money on their stalls. Expensive displays, professionally produced materials, large-scale advertisements, or other high-cost additions will not give a team an advantage.

Teams should focus on making the greatest possible impact with the resources available to them. A simple, creatively executed stall can outperform a more expensive setup.

All aspects of the stall's preparation and execution must be handled by the three delegates themselves. Teams may not rely on outside individuals, hired help, or professional services to design, construct, decorate, or operate their stall. Any additional materials brought by teams should remain within the competition's permitted resources and spending limit.

Judging Criteria:

- Creativity and shock value
- Brand consistency and connection to earlier rounds
- Visual appeal and presentation
- Audience engagement and memorability
- Ability to adapt to the assigned audience
- Resourcefulness and effective use of limited resources
- Quality and persuasiveness of pitch
- Feasibility
- Product Positioning
- Market Awareness

Guidelines:

- Teams must consist of 2 to 3 delegates
- No eliminations will occur until Round 2
- Cumulative scoring will determine the winners
- Use of AI is prohibited

NOTE: The proceedings of each round may be altered at the sole discretion of the category heads.